

Daniel Wayne Cook

[in LinkedIn](#) | [210-990-9940](tel:210-990-9940) | danielcook.org | danielwcook5@gmail.com | [GitHub](#)

Career Objective

Cybersecurity graduate with hands-on experience in malware analysis, threat detection, vulnerability scanning, and SIEM log analysis. Adept in Python scripting, cloud security, and setting up virtual attack/defense environments. Seeking a cybersecurity analyst or entry-level security engineer role to apply both academic and lab-based technical experience.

Skills

- Languages/Tools: Python, React, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Git, Docker
- Cybersecurity & Cloud: Azure, Malware Analysis, SIEM (Splunk/ELK), Vulnerability Management, Penetration Testing, Wireshark, PESTudio, YARA, pfSense, Kali Linux, Burp Suite
- Security Techniques: *Threat Hunting, Reverse Engineering, IDS/IPS Setup, Log Analysis, Network Hardening, Scripting, XUnit*
- Other: *Full-Stack Development, GitHub, CI/CD, Microservices, Distributed Systems*

Projects

- **Vulnerability Scanner – Custom Python Tool**
 - Built a Python-based web scanner to detect live hosts, open ports, and HTTP vulnerabilities.
 - Implemented socket connection testing, HTTP response analysis, and service fingerprinting.
 - Used custom functions and banner grabbing to identify potentially insecure headers and services.
- **Home Lab – Offensive & Defensive Security**
 - Created a full virtual environment using **VirtualBox**, **pfSense**, and **Kali Linux** for simulated attacks.
 - Performed network scans, **privilege escalation**, **MITM attacks**, and configured pfSense firewall rules.
 - Simulated blue-team response using IDS logs, packet capture analysis, and system hardening techniques.
- **SIEM Log Analysis & Threat Detection**
 - Deployed a **Splunk-based SIEM** to analyze logs from Windows/Linux VMs.
 - Built dashboards and alerts for **brute force detection**, suspicious logins, and **data exfiltration attempts**.
 - Tuned correlation rules and analyzed live attacks using Wireshark and real-time log streams.
- **Wireless Network Security Audit**
 - Audited a home wireless network using **aircrack-ng**, **Wireshark**, and **Kismet**.
 - Identified insecure protocols, rogue device attempts, and SSID leakage.
 - Produced a remediation report with CVSS scoring and risk-based recommendations.
- **DanOS – Interactive Web-Based Operating System Simulation**
 - Designed and developed a fully interactive OS simulation using **Next.js**, **React**, and **TypeScript**, replicating file system operations and multi-window task behavior in-browser.
 - Integrated **sandboxed environments** for user interaction, reflecting concepts of **access control**, **user permissions**, and UI process management.
 - Implemented real-time file and folder manipulation, custom desktop interface, and persistent user session handling.
 - Demonstrated web security best practices in client-side rendering, isolated component access, and session simulation.

Experience

Generative AI Engineer (Freelance)	Outlier.ai	Remote	11/24 - Current
• Tuned AI models for code generation and natural language processing in a secure development lifecycle. • Integrated Python-based data filtering scripts into human-in-the-loop AI training workflows. • Partnered with product teams to optimize model performance and task reliability.			
Customer Service Representative	UniFirst	San Antonio, TX, US	09/2024 - 11/2024
• Managed incoming customer calls and resolved inquiries using internal systems, achieving a 95% satisfaction rate. • Collaborated with Sales and Service teams to track and resolve customer requests.			
Teaching Assistant – Malware Analysis	University of Texas at San Antonio	San Antonio, TX, US	01/2024 - 05/2024
• Assisted undergraduates in malware reverse engineering, static/dynamic analysis, and YARA rule creation. • Led lab sessions on PESTudio, Bstrings, and sandbox testing to dissect malicious binaries. • Provided support on incident response concepts and simulated malware infection chains.			
Sales – Computers (Seasonal)	Best Buy	Corpus Christi, TX, US	11/2018 – 01/2019
• Led technology sales efforts, averaging \$20K monthly in personal sales.			

Education

Bachelor of Business Administration	University of Texas at San Antonio	San Antonio, TX, US	08/2021 - 05/2024
• Major in Cyber Security – 3.57 GPA ➤ Awards: <i>Cum Laude, President's List, Dean's List</i> ➤ Relevant Courses: <i>Cloud Computing, Web Application Security, Malware Analysis</i>			

Certification

- Google Cyber Security Professional Certificate | Issued October 2024
- CompTIA Security+ (In Progress)

Community Involvement

- *100 Club of San Antonio | Volunteer | Apr 2022 – Aug 2024*
 - Supported public fundraisers and parades for families of fallen first responders.